

Ἀσκληπιός ὁ Ἰατρός

Asclepius the Physician on Aristotle's Metaphysics

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Period: Ἀρχαϊκή [Archaic](#)
Dialect: Ἑπική [Epic \(Homeric\)](#)
Domain: Φιλοσοφία [Philosophy](#)
Format: Πραγματεία [Treatise](#)

Asclepius the Physician is not a historical figure from the 5th century BCE. The name Asclepius belongs to the Greek god of medicine, a mythical hero and demigod said to be the son of Apollo and Coronis. He was worshipped at major healing sanctuaries such as those at Epidaurus and Cos. The notion of a 5th-century philosophical figure by this name is incompatible with the established divine persona.

No treatises or writings are attributed to the god Asclepius. Medical knowledge was instead associated with his cult and his mythical descendants, the Asclepiadae, a lineage that included historical physicians like Hippocrates. Any later pseudepigraphical texts bearing his name do not relate to a 5th-century author.

As the god of medicine, Asclepius held profound cultural and religious significance. His sanctuaries functioned as healing centers that employed therapeutic rituals such as incubation. The Hippocratic Oath invokes him, cementing his role in the professional identity of ancient physicians. His symbol, the Rod of Asclepius, remains a universal emblem of medicine.

Works (2)

- Σχόλια εἰς τὴν Νικομάχου Γερασίου Ἀριθμητικὴν · [Commentary-Nicomachus of Gerasa's Introduction to Arithmetic](#) · 226 passages
- Σχόλια εἰς τὰ μεταφυσικὰ Ἀριστοτέλους, Βιβλία Α-Ω · [On Aristotle's Metaphysics Books A-Z. Commentary](#) · 452 passages